



PROGRESS REPORT

Kenya: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-29 · 240 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY ·
INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-29.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	The digital public infrastructure roadmap is the section's central coordinating instrument and the base holds no text of it. It is under development on five pillars, launched at an inaugural inter-ministerial steering committee (roadmap , launch). A technical-assistance tender was issued in July 2026 with offers closing 1 September, a German development agency having funded a work package inside a European service contract to develop a bankable national project; no roadmap document, timetable or cost is published (tender). The digital programme is named a priority sector in the FY2027/28 budget process, with no ceiling, figure or timetable published (budget process).	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	A business process outsourcing policy is claimed delivered with no text or adoption date on file, and the authority bill behind it is unwritten. Both sit on the ministry's forward legislative list, the outsourcing policy claimed as delivered and the authority bill named as a priority with no text, sponsor or stage held (legislative push). A harmonised county wayleave framework was agreed between the information technology and devolution departments, to be tabled at the intergovernmental sector forum, with no framework text, timetable, cost or wayleave figure published (wayleave framework).	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	Against a target of 100,000km of fibre and 25,000 hotspots, the regulator reports 2,193km deployed and 1,173 last-mile sites connected. The targets were restated for 2026 by the information technology authority (targets), and the delivered figures are for the universal-service-funded slice of the programme at 30 June 2025 (annual report). FY2026/27 carries KSh 1.3bn for backbone maintenance and KSh 528m for last-mile county connectivity (allocations). The only delivered-kilometre figures published anywhere are the fund's own (annual report), so the target is measured against about 2 per cent of itself.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	Cloud policy implementation guidelines opened provider accreditation in August 2026 and give state organs 24 months to migrate non-exempted systems. The 99-page document is signed by the Cabinet Secretary and cover-dated June 2026, grading providers into four accreditation classes with a register on the ministry website and a supplier-and-buyer marketplace administered by a cloud adoption committee (guidelines). Accreditation opened before that committee had been constituted (accreditation). The cloud policy the guidelines implement is itself not held: it carries a cloud-first mandate for the public sector and is cited as anchoring domestic data-centre demand, and the base dates it 2024 in one source and 2025 in another (policy , demand).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	The national strategy's roadmap is costed at KSh 152bn over five years with no dedicated allocation in the FY2026/27 budget. The roadmap was published in February 2026 with an 80 per cent fifth-generation population-coverage target by 2030 (roadmap); the strategy document itself is not held and its publication date is not established (roadmap , costing , governance politics). A 226-page draft policy is out for consultation with a risk-based lifecycle model, effects-based extraterritorial reach, binding worker standards and a disclosure duty, high risk undefined and penalties unstated; it proposes a national council and a safety institute, and a civil-society submission urges institutional independence for the council and mandatory human-rights impact assessments (draft policy , submission , worker standards). A standing Cabinet committee was established on 30 June 2026 to steer the strategy and coordinate policy across ministries, with no membership, meeting record or output published; it reaches the base through a university analysis rather than a gazette (Cabinet committee).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	A draft national data governance policy of May 2026 schedules implementation from July, with the personal and non-personal boundary undefined. The pricing method is deferred, and the draft text is not held (draft policy , monetisation question). It was workshopped with the United States State Department on 10 July 2026 (workshop). It remains on the information technology principal secretary's forward list as still to be completed, which is a different position from the implementation start the draft itself schedules.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy	A state-run data marketplace is proposed at KSh 396m to build and operate, offering more than 1,000 datasets over five years. It would be overseen by a proposed national council, with pricing deferred to a later phase and no valuation method stated (marketplace , draft policy). The proposal is to sell state data rather than to open it, and it sits inside the same draft policy that leaves the personal and non-personal boundary undefined, which is the question a marketplace would have to answer first.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The 2019 Act is in force, and a court awarded eleven petitioners KES 900,000 each for a sustained compromise of subscriber data. The regulator is now stretching the Act's cross-border-transfer duties to reach offshore artificial-intelligence processing (the Act , quality standards). The judgment of 13 May 2026 found a sustained and systematic compromise; the telco is not named in the account held and the judgment text is not on file (judgment). On the receiving side, 15 of 224 betting and gaming firms were fully registered as both controller and processor, with 185 unregistered and given 40 days or licence cancellation, and no follow-up is on file after the deadline expired (registration ultimatum). The gambling regulator has an open investigation into three licensees, with the criminal investigations directorate requesting its entire record back to 2018 — the first move against recipients of leaked subscriber data rather than the leakers (investigation).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	The Court of Appeal struck the false-publication sections and a shutdown power, while cyber cafe logging rules take effect in September 2026. The 2018 statute is narrowed by litigation, with the false-publication offences and the non-judicial website-shutdown power struck and a conservatory order blocking a national internet shutdown; the base does not date the judgments, so whether the narrowing falls inside the twelve months is unestablished (litigation). Operators of public access centres must capture each customer's name and identity number, the terminal used and session times, and retain the records at least three years, on pain of fines of up to 0.2 per cent of annual turnover with a minimum of about US\$3,860 (rules). The regulator clarified on 13 August 2026 that the conditions do not require operators to track browsing history; the conditions were gazetted on 7 August and take effect on 7 September 2026 (clarification).	MIXED the cybercrime statute was narrowed by litigation while new logging duties were imposed on public access centres
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	The High Court recognised a registered phone number as a personal digital identifier and gave the Attorney-General six months to legislate. The judgment also bars recycling of dormant numbers without consent; the window was still open as at 12 August 2026 with nothing tabled and closes about September (judgment). Analysis of it argues the judgment should produce a coordinated number-recycling policy binding banks, savings societies and platforms that keep relying on numbers after reassignment (analysis). It is the only instrument in the base that defines a digital identifier in law, and it arrived through litigation rather than through Parliament.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	Virtual asset regulations were gazetted in July 2026 with joint licensing across ten categories, and existing operators have until November to transition. The 2025 Act commenced on 4 November 2025, giving pre-existing operators a year to comply (the Act). The regulations set capital by licence class from KES 300m for stablecoin issuance to nil for advisers, with a seizure and freezing framework; the draft ownership cap was dropped between draft and gazette, and the Finance Bill replaces a proposed 3 per cent transfer tax with a 10 per cent excise duty on provider fees (regulations , compliance cost). Six named exchanges have said they intend to apply, and the regulators had not announced the application process as at 7 August 2026 (applicants). On mobile money the position is different in kind: the central bank's pricing principles operate through voluntary operator alignment, with no gazetted tariff rule or determination to cite, appeal or extend to a competitor, reversible at the operator's discretion (pricing principles).	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	Two tracks run in parallel: a governance act under debate and an artificial intelligence bill before the Senate transplanting the European statute. The Senate bill is a self-declared transplant with a presidentially appointed commissioner and fines capped at KES 5m, on a separate legislative track from the ministry's draft policy; the bill text is not held (Senate bill , copyright and AI). A human-rights organisation argued on 24 August 2026 that the governance act carries no child-specific protections and no consultation mechanism, setting it against the country's membership of a children's protection coalition and against a global drive to age assurance that the analysis argues adds data trails and surveillance risk rather than closing the harms it names; the act's text, sponsor and date remain unestablished (critique).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	A copyright bill and an intellectual property bill are both out for comment, alongside an adopted inter-agency piracy enforcement framework. The copyright bill would create a copyright authority and a disputes tribunal, and carries the 2001 computer-generated-work authorship rule forward unchanged; its comment window's closing date is not on file (copyright bill). The intellectual property bill would merge the industrial property institute, the copyright board and the anti-counterfeit authority into one regulator with a tribunal, replace the 2001 and 2008 statutes, and set rules distinguishing artificial-intelligence-assisted from artificial-intelligence-generated inventions (property bill). An inter-agency digital piracy enforcement framework was adopted on a steering committee's hundred-day report, with the ministry coordinating the copyright board, the regulator, the media council and the tribunal; a national policy on digital piracy is announced as the next step with no draft, drafter or date (framework , losses).	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	An amendment bill would criminalise sharing classified information through personal messaging or email, on four classification tiers. No sponsor, stage or timetable is on file (bill). It is the only access-to-information instrument in the base, and it narrows rather than widens: the record holds no compliance figure, request statistic or enforcement action under the existing regime against which to read it.	REGRESSED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data protection	Data protection authority	The regulator took a first separate appropriation of KSh 917.3m, on a caseload last stated at 7,128 complaints in March 2025. The appropriation is projected to KSh 1,328m by 2028/29, and through FY2025/26 the regulator had no separately visible line (appropriation). The caseload figure carries 215 determinations, and the regulator self-reports 97 per cent of complaints resolved, penalties on 10 entities, 103 compensations and 39 alternative-dispute resolutions (caseload); no later caseload, determination count or penalty total has been published (caseload , restatement). A five-year privacy plan launched at KES 12.6bn in July 2025 has produced no spend, milestone or progress statement since (plan), and a quality management system launched in July 2026 with donor support still awaits its external certification audit (quality system). No national count of registered controllers and processors exists at any date; only the betting-sector subset is held (registration).	MIXED the regulator gained its first separate appropriation while its published caseload has not moved in eighteen months

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data protection	National data protection readiness	Three draft guidance notes issued in July 2026 read the Act onto artificial intelligence, emerging technologies and privacy-enhancing technologies. The artificial-intelligence note runs to 36 pages and would require a lawful transfer basis and a documented adequacy assessment before any transfer to an offshore processor, registration of every entity deploying the technology on Kenyan data subjects' data, an impact assessment before any high-risk deployment, and obligations mapped across a seven-stage lifecycle applying to procured systems as to built ones (artificial intelligence note). The emerging technologies note runs to 31 pages across the internet of things, cloud, blockchain, biometric recognition classified three ways, extended reality and connected vehicles (emerging technologies), and a 38-page note reads adoption of privacy-enhancing technologies as a statutory obligation under privacy by design (privacy technologies). None states a transition period or commencement, and nothing on their face says whether they bind or guide. Earlier draft notes on biometric processing and risk-based age assurance, issued in May 2025, are still in draft as far as the base establishes (biometrics and age assurance).	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	The country is recorded as a non-signatory to the continental cyber and data convention in an August 2026 peer-reviewed review. The review of health-data governance in four countries records only one of the four as a signatory, and finds all four frameworks fragmented with weak cross-border transfer harmonisation and capacity gaps (review). So the country that leads the region on domestic data-protection enforcement is outside the continental instrument that would harmonise it, and no signature, ratification or authorisation appears anywhere in the base.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	Four states opened a joint account to fund a feasibility study for a regional communications satellite, with deposits due 30 September 2026. The account takes partner-state contributions under a roadmap settled at an April 2026 meeting, and neither the study's cost nor each state's share was disclosed (joint account). On terrestrial infrastructure the cross-border link with Tanzania was launched in July 2026, integrating the neighbour's backbone with the Mombasa landings (link).	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	A United States health framework signed in December 2025 was frozen by injunction, with a final ruling reported due at end-October 2026. It runs five years with US\$1,631,470,000 of planned United States support across FY2026 to FY2030 including US\$175,000,000 for health data systems (framework); the US\$2.5bn headline is that figure plus the country's own pledged increase in domestic health spending, not a competing number (framework , litigation). The signed text makes audit information subject to Kenyan law and to the data-protection regulator's concurrence, and makes specimen testing and data sharing subject to Kenyan law rather than the template's five-day transfer; the subsidiary data sharing agreement has not been published. The suspension of the data-transfer component was reversed on appeal in May 2026 (appeal). A rights organisation reading the seven signed memoranda places this country outside both the three committing to hand over data without explicit privacy safeguards and the five requiring unilateral specimen sharing (assessment). In the other direction the country is one of the first three selected to implement shared cross-border rails for identity, payments and trusted data exchange, chosen on political commitment, regulatory alignment, technical capacity and system maturity; no national implementation plan, budget or timetable is published (continental pilot).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	National interoperability standards	Two health interoperability implementation guides were published in August 2026, both served as continuous builds rather than authorised publications. A core guide stands at version 1.0.0 and a patient summary guide at 0.1.0, and both pages state they are not authorised publications; no gazettment, conformance requirement or implementer list is held (core guide , patient summary). Four foundational digital-health governance documents were launched at a health summit on 21 August 2026, together establishing the architecture for governing, connecting and using health data that three decades of collection had left without a shared framework; the documents are not individually named in the record and no commencement or compliance date is stated (foundational documents).	ADVANCED
Standards	National quality standards	Equipment vendor and public access centre licence conditions were gazetted in August 2026, and a distributor licence made mandatory before type approval. The vendor conditions carry a twelve-month minimum warranty, returns, after-sales support and record-keeping duties, and both categories were gazetted in the same notice after public consultation, effective 30 days from it and published for free download (gazette notice , consumer protection). A separate distributor licence is mandatory before equipment type approval and customs clearance, at KSh 1m or three years for non-compliance; fee, holding threshold and grandfathering are unestablished and the gazette notice is not held (distributor licence).	ADVANCED
Standards	Adoption of international standards	Cooperation with the European delegation was reaffirmed across artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, digital identity, interoperability and digital governance. The reaffirmation came at a principal-secretary-level meeting, and no agreement text, workplan, timetable or funding figure is published (meeting). It is the only standards-alignment engagement in the base, and the country's own standards work — cloud accreditation classes, health interoperability guides, equipment licence conditions — is domestic and not framed against any international instrument on the record.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	A EUR 1.3m digital-rights project closed after 30 months, its 49-member coalition continuing unfunded. It reported 18,000 reached directly, 9.4m through campaigns and 133 defenders trained (close-out , grant). Civil society is the constituency that made the running on this ledger — the submissions on the artificial-intelligence policy, the warnings on metered billing, the petitions on automated decisioning and on borrower data — and the funded structure that carried much of it has closed.	REGRESSED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	A joint framework for digital platform governance is in drafting that would replace safe-harbour immunity with earned protection. It was reviewed technically with an international body and the regulator in July 2026 and would add a joint regulatory oversight committee; no draft text, sponsor department or timetable is held (framework). Separately, a former deputy president told reporters on 24 August 2026 that the electoral commission's results-transmission contract specifications were tailor-made for a single foreign bidder, that every other competitor has gone to the procurement appeals board, and that the firm has failed at every election it has taken part in; the report names neither company nor contract, and no commission or appeals-board response is on file (allegation). The nineteenth Kenya Internet Governance Forum met under the Africa Tech Policy Summit with more than 300 participants and published its report on 27 August 2026, confirming Kenya as host of the global forum for the first time since 2011 (forum).	ADVANCED

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	The information technology vote fell to KSh 12,763.8m for FY2026/27 from KSh 16,188.8m, and the digital thematic to KSh 8.6bn from KSh 16.3bn two years ago. FY2025/26 was itself revised down to KSh 12,215.1m at the first supplementary (estimates , prior year). The thematic allocation fell to KSh 8.6bn for FY2026/27 from KSh 12.7bn, a second consecutive cut (thematic , prior thematic). Inside it, KSh 400m is appropriated for establishing digital hubs and KSh 528m for last-mile county connectivity maintenance, against an Auditor-General finding that 70 per cent of sampled county connectivity offices had no internet at all (hub and connectivity lines).	REGRESSED
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	A European digital partnership committed KSh 15.3bn including EUR 37m to a submarine cable, and a justice-innovation memorandum was signed in August 2026. The partnership's instrument type, disbursement schedule and implementing channel are not established (partnership). The judiciary signed a memorandum with a Netherlands justice-innovation institute at the Supreme Court, with an intergovernmental development-law organisation and the Netherlands embassy participating, building on the country's access-to-justice blueprint; no value, term or deliverable is stated (memorandum).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	Four development-finance transactions closed in mid-2026, from a US\$25m tower facility to a US\$24.2m first-loss guarantee. The tower facility sits inside a US\$30m multi-currency package financing new macro towers and expanded mobile capacity (tower debt). A EUR270m senior facility across 21 obligors in eight jurisdictions includes a local-currency tranche of up to EUR20m equivalent funding fibre-infrastructure modernisation here, with an uncommitted EUR100m for future acquisitions (telecom facility). The guarantee committed US\$24.2m across three lenders with US\$11m of concessional backing, expected to catalyse about US\$144.4m in local-currency lending to micro-enterprises (guarantee); it is the programme's first transaction anywhere in Africa, only one counterparty is a digital lender, and the catalysed figure is an expectation rather than a disbursement (guarantee , announcement). Separately, about KSh38.8 billion of planned investment in towers, smart cities, data centres, fibre, cloud and green digital technologies was stated by a principal secretary as a Chinese group's plan, with no agreement, timetable, site or financing instrument (stated plan).	ADVANCED
New investments	Development-partner project financing	The US\$390m digital acceleration project had disbursed US\$33.93m in its third year, and takes KSh 4.3bn of the FY2026/27 estimates. The operation closes in October 2028 and the portal reading is from June 2026 (project). Its FY2026/27 appropriation of KSh 4.3bn is half the entire digital thematic, up from KSh 3.7bn, and equips more than 10,000 junior secondary schools (appropriation , devolution partnership). So a single donor operation carries half the sector's budget line while having disbursed under a tenth of its own commitment three years in.	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	The dominant operator took a 25-year unified licence in May 2026, consolidating spectrum and authorisations against a historic ten-year term. Licence-related costs were about US\$126.7m in the year to March 2026, and the prior position was a temporary two-year unified permit (licence). A twenty-five-year term is the longest regulatory commitment in the base, and it was granted to the operator the base separately records as dominant in mobile money and designated systemically critical.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet usage	Smartphone connections passed 50m for the first time in March 2026, with feature phones falling to 28.5m. They stood at 48.7m against 29.6m in December 2025 (devices). The statistics office's own chapter, a year behind, puts fixed and wireless internet subscriptions at 57.8m in 2024 (survey). The crossover is the clearest usage signal the base holds, and the regulator publishes it quarterly while the statistics office publishes annually and later.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	A bill proposing consumption-based internet billing drew warnings from two providers that per-megabyte metering would force deep packet inspection into their networks. They told Parliament it would hand subscriber-level usage to the regulator, raise consumer prices, break fixed-speed broadband pricing and conflict with data minimisation, and a jurists' commission warned the central store could be used to monitor activists, journalists and political opponents; the reporting establishes no precedent for the regime in any national market (submissions , assessment , warning). The Bill's own gazetted text runs to four clauses, of which one brings internet service providers inside the definition of telecommunication operator and another preserves existing licences until expiry; the only verification duty in it is the user's verification of an invoice, and the subscriber-verification duty reported from the commentaries is not in the text (the Bill).	REGRESSED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	A cross-border terrestrial link with Tanzania was launched in July 2026, integrating the neighbour's backbone with the Mombasa landings. It was delivered by the information technology authority with the Tanzanian state operator at two border points; no capacity, cost or route length is stated (link). It is the only completed backbone build in the base with a date on it, against a national target of 100,000km measured at about 2,193km delivered.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	Two new submarine systems are expected, taking the country from seven landings to nine. A 10,000km France to Middle East system routed through Africa is expected by a research firm to land in 2027, which is a forecast rather than an operator or landing-party statement (forecast). A 4,108km system with 24 fibre pairs from Salalah to Mombasa at US\$23m was ready for service in 2026 on its announcement, with the incumbent named landing and operating partner (cable); nothing held records landing, testing or service readiness (cable).	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	The Nairobi exchange carries more than 55 connected networks and combined Nairobi and Mombasa traffic of 330 Gbps, twentyfold in a year. Connected networks include a major video platform and a satellite operator (exchange). The baseline is inferred from the stated twentyfold growth rather than separately published, so the direction is firmer than the level.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Satellite broadband reached 24,999 subscribers and 0.9 per cent of fixed share, with new orders in seven counties diverted to a waitlist. It stood at 17,425 subscribers and 0.8 per cent share in the quarter to June 2025 on 359 net adds (earlier quarter); by March 2026 it was a top-ten fixed provider with median speed of 34.55 Mbps, down 26 per cent year on year, and sign-ups in seven counties were suspended to a deposit-backed waitlist (cap). A direct-to-handset pilot with the second mobile operator was declared complete and awaits regulator approval; it would be the country's first such service on compatible handsets with no extra module or charge (pilot). A spectrum-interference audit opened in March 2026 with its conclusion put at mid-year had produced no finding, clearance or refusal as at August (audit). Separately a hyperscaler's constellation has applied for a fifteen-year international gateway licence covering an earth station and network control centre, the wholesale route into the market rather than the household one; neither the regulator's decision nor a determination date is held (gateway application).	MIXED subscribers grew while new sign-ups were capped in seven counties and two approvals stalled

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Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	The largest operating campus targets 22.5MW, while a 44MW build slipped to July 2027 and a 100MW geothermal project stalled on commercial terms. The operating campus is the anchor site for a hyperscaler cloud region, two sovereign clouds and an artificial-intelligence lab, with 11 acres bought for a second Nairobi campus (expansion , anchor role). The 44MW build runs in two phases at US\$150m with a dedicated 135 MVA substation in a special economic zone and on-site solar (deferral); anchor-tenant talks with four hyperscalers rest on the operator's word alone (deferral , groundbreaking). The geothermal project broke ground in 2023 on a 60MW masterplan and was rescoped in 2024 to a 100MW first phase with stated potential to 1GW (rescoping , groundbreaking); at the same site a US\$1bn, 100MW build targeting a May 2026 launch has broken no ground, the sponsors having asked the government to guarantee annual uptake of capacity including by neighbouring countries and the government having declined (stall , power constraint). A foreign firm has separately proposed a US\$1.5bn offshore facility powered by liquefied natural gas and designed to bypass the grid, with no capacity, timeline or site disclosed (proposal).	MIXED one campus is financed and building while the two largest announced projects have stalled or slipped

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Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	The state data centre runs 706 kW certified capacity against about 300 kW actual load, hosting 145 of 451 government institutions. It has 144 racks with 100 in use and is certified to the third tier in design and construction; expansion to 288 racks and 1 to 2 MW is being structured as a public-private partnership, and no allocation for it was disclosed at FY2026/27 budget day against KSh 3.1bn the year before (capacity , budget). Three sovereign clouds run on commercial premises instead: one billing in shillings with zero egress and in-country residency (sovereign cloud), a graphics-processor platform for artificial-intelligence workloads with no capacity or customer figure published since launch (artificial intelligence cloud), and a hyperscaler region confirmed at more than 20MW when fully built and up to 50 kW per rack, still listed as coming soon (cloud region , announcement).	REGRESSED the state facility's expansion moved to a partnership route with no allocation disclosed
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	About 3GW of installed supply stands against a 10GW-by-2030 target, and a single 1GW facility would take a third of it. Every power arrangement the base holds is bilateral: no published regulator or utility data-centre tariff, and no gazetted large-load connection rule exists (power arrangements). The absence has a cost the base can name. The largest announced build stalled after its sponsors asked the state to guarantee capacity uptake, and a separate proposal is designed to bypass the grid entirely with its own gas generation.	NO CHANGE
Energy	Grid reliability		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Rural electrification		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	A broadcast logger and monitoring room completed nationwide deployment, with joint regulator and classification-board training concluded in July 2026. No cost, coverage or channel-count figure is disclosed (training). It is the only completed government technical deployment in the base with a nationwide claim attached, and its purpose is monitoring broadcast content rather than delivering a service.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	An advanced institute of science and technology has its charter issued and its operationalisation under review, with no FY2026/27 allocation disclosed. KSh 2.3bn was appropriated in FY2025/26 for continued construction at the technopolis, and the review with a foreign export-import bank states no commitment amount (review , prior appropriation). It is the country's only named institution for building the technical capacity its own systems require, and it has a charter and no operating budget on the record.	STALLED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	A national cyber security agency was established as an autonomous state corporation at about KSh 4bn, against 2.35 billion threat events in one quarter. Its mandate covers critical-infrastructure audit and certification, an operations centre and incident coordination, where cyber duties had been split across four bodies; the inaugural non-executive chair was announced on 24 August 2026, and whether the delegated legislation committee approved before the ministry announced it is contested (chair , approval , contest). The regulator recorded 2.35 billion threat events in the quarter to June 2026, chiefly web-application attacks, and an international police body puts the country second on the continent for exploitable vulnerabilities detected in 2025 (events). The presidential website was defaced in July 2026 with a 5 BTC ransom demand, the second inside twelve months, with cause and attribution undisclosed (defacement , earlier breach). KSh 457.2m was appropriated for cyber space management plus KSh 382m for programme cybersecurity (appropriation), a EUR 3m European-funded project runs to 36 months (project), and a bilateral partnership is running with no funding, deliverable or date stated (partnership , review). The regulator estimates cybercrime losses of at least KSh 29bn a year, an estimate rather than a measurement (losses). A national cybersecurity policy remains on the forward list with nothing drafted, so the agency, the appropriation and the partnerships all precede the policy that would direct them (forward list).	ADVANCED

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	A health tender makes eight cross-government systems day-one mandatory interfaces, the clearest written interoperability baseline the base holds. Financial management, central bank interfaces, tax, health insurance, pensions, payroll, laboratory systems and identity management are all mandatory from day one, with primary hosting required in an approved government or health-sector environment (enterprise addendum , laboratory addendum). It is a tender document rather than a national standard, which is the finding: the country's firmest interoperability requirement is a procurement condition on one ministry's system. Separately the Treasury is rolling out a system to consolidate development-partner commitments, disbursements and funded programmes, with launch expected before the end of 2026 and no supplier, cost or statement of whether the consolidated data will be public (Treasury system).	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	Biometric health identification was extended to dependants aged 7 to 17, each issued a national identifier linked to their health record. It launched at a teaching hospital in August 2025 with 29 biometric devices and is operational in all level four to six public facilities (launch , extension). Enrolling children into a biometric health register against the national identifier is the deepest integration of the identity system in the base, and no impact assessment, consent model or retention rule for the children's biometrics is on the record.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	Data exchange regulations designate the shared health registries as critical information infrastructure and make access to them fee-bearing. The designated resources are the national health data dictionary, client registry, facility registry, health worker registry, the health enterprise architecture and the national logistics system (regulations). The Health Cabinet Secretary stated on 4 August 2026 that the charge is 2 per cent of each transaction capped at KSh 5,000, payable to the digital health agency (the charge); the schedule setting the fee is served as a heading with no table under it, so the rate cannot be read from the gazetted text (the charge). A per-transaction fee on access to the national health registries is the base's only instance of interoperability priced rather than mandated.	NO CHANGE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	More than 42m identity records were digitised in FY2025/26, with enrolment extended to dependants aged 7 to 17. KSh 15.13bn was committed in FY2024/25 for 7.5m cards and unique personal identifier rollout, and first-time fees were scrapped in March 2025 (commitment , fees scrapped); no dated series of cards issued, applicants enrolled or backlog is held (digitisation). The population management vote holds near its supplementary peak at KSh 10,993.0m for FY2026/27, against KSh 8,085.6m in the prior year's original estimates (vote , prior year). Government is procuring a system to cut card issuance to ten days and passports to a week, on a headline-only source with no contract, vendor or value held (procurement).	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	Talks opened with a foreign secure-identity provider on a platform letting citizens reach public and private services on one digital identity. Both sides agreed to deepen technical and policy collaboration towards an interoperable identity architecture under ministry-wide governance; no contract, procurement, value or timetable is stated (talks). A verifiable-credential wallet proof of concept was completed for the public service commission after an audit found over 2,000 fake certificates, with no single credential database and no production decision or funding on file (proof of concept).	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth	A statute mandates a civil-registration office in each of 290 sub-counties, with the identifier issued at birth feeding automatic identity at 18. The amendment Act was assented in February 2026, shifting vetting to birth registration (statute , reform direction). A digital birth-notification system links hospitals to the registry against the national identifier, live in one county and one hospital, with no national rollout date or facility count on file (notification).	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	The High Court barred discontinuation of physical vehicle logbooks pending a petition on public participation and data-protection assessments. The electronic system stands but cannot replace the paper one while the order holds; the petition argues it was introduced without public participation and without adequate data-protection and cybersecurity impact assessments (order). A compulsory digital seller identifier for electronic commerce was proposed by the trade ministry and is still a proposal with nothing on record being built (proposal).	MIXED an electronic logbook was suspended by court order while a seller identifier remains a proposal

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The central bank is designing a fast payment system and national switch amid heavy lobbying, with no award. Three contenders are named and no design document, timetable or award is on file (contest). The bank's other principal act in the window was to set mobile-money pricing principles that operate through voluntary operator alignment, so on both the switch and the tariff the regulator's position rests on negotiation rather than on an instrument.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	The state micro-loan fund has disbursed Sh90 billion to 28 million registered borrowers, against state funding down from KSh 20bn to KSh 300m. Sh76 billion has been repaid with Sh13.7 billion outstanding, Sh7 billion saved by borrowers and 10 million repeat borrowers; the figures are the fund's chief executive and the president's own, and the claim that 4.5 million customers moved to better credit scores is not independently held (four-year account). Default runs at 15 per cent, about KSh 12.5bn, and the Auditor-General found 104,631 loans worth KSh 116.5m issued to borrowers with no identity details on file (default and audit). Repayment through a privately issued loyalty balance went live in July 2026, five points settling one shilling, recovering KSh 3m in the first week — a private loyalty currency converting into public-money recovery at a rate the issuer sets (loyalty repayment).	REGRESSED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	Electronic procurement carries more than 1,500 entities against a projected Sh86 billion of savings, and electronic invoicing became comprehensive in January 2026. The platform ties treasury disbursement to procurements actually made and carries budgeting and procurement plans together; the savings figure is a government projection from full uptake rather than a measured outturn, and no transaction volume is published (procurement, appropriation). Electronic invoicing moved to comprehensive income and expenses validation across the entire commercial sector from 1 January 2026 — the opposite approach to the phased sector-by-sector rollouts two neighbours adopted, so three regional revenue administrations run unharmonised regimes; the underlying instruments are not held here and no compliance or coverage figures are stated (invoicing).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	An equity-trading service on the dominant wallet reportedly took 40 per cent of trades by number in its first days. It launched in February 2026 with a brokerage, opening exchange equities to wallet customers without a conventional brokerage account, and accounted for about 5 per cent of daily trading value (service). A wallet becoming the largest retail route into the securities exchange by transaction count is the clearest instance in the base of payments infrastructure carrying a function it was not built for.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	The dominant wallet's business tariffs were cut from 7 August 2026, with merchant payments fee-free to KES 500 and transfer bands down by up to 49.5 per cent. Merchant receipts are fee-free to KES 500 from KES 200, and the small-trader product to KES 200 from KES 100 with fees capped for 90 days; it was delivered as voluntary alignment with central bank pricing principles, with no legal notice or gazetted schedule to cite (tariffs). A single application replaced the separate wallet and account apps in April 2026, with the standalone apps to be decommissioned six months after launch (single app). The second operator launched a dedicated business wallet, free to fund and returning half of transaction fees as in-wallet cashback, on a 10.9 per cent mobile-money share (business wallet).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	94.09m registered mobile-money accounts and 564,330 active agents in May 2026, with the dominant service on 40.99m 30-day-active customers. Registered accounts rose from 87.46m and agents from 451,157 in August 2025, with agent cash movement of KSh 681.45bn in the month (central bank release). The dominant service reported KES 182.7bn revenue, KES 41.68tn transacted and 89.1 per cent market share in the year to March 2026, from 35.82m active customers and about 98 per cent share a year earlier (results); the central bank classified it systemically critical in January 2026 (results , designation). Formal financial inclusion is put at 83.7 per cent of adults against 26.7 per cent in 2006, on operator disclosure rather than an independent survey (inclusion), and a record KSh 1.4tn was disbursed through the overdraft product with the repayment ratio flat year on year (overdraft).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	A national switch links more than 80 institutions to the pan-African settlement system, the first such national-switch pilot. A commercial bank group went live on 11 August 2026, adding its branch network to instant cross-border transfers in local currencies (go-live). Online card acceptance for one international network extended to nine African markets, settling in local currency, dollars or both, with nearly 900 participating merchants across the nine and no country-specific count given (card acceptance).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	Phone-number masking went live on person-to-person transfers in March 2026, with extension to merchant and bank transfers targeted for end-2026. Masking had previously been limited to the small-trader product (masking). It is a design change made by the operator rather than a regulatory requirement, and it addresses the same exposure — a phone number functioning as an identifier — that the High Court has since recognised in law.	ADVANCED
Registries	Population register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Civil register	Birth certificates became downloadable and printable online after application, where collection had required a visit. The change was announced by the Interior Cabinet Secretary in June 2026 (announcement). It completes online delivery for one document at the point where the statute now requires a civil-registration office in each of 290 sub-counties, so the register is being made both more local and less visited at once.	ADVANCED
Registries	Address register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Business register	A five-year memorandum would harmonise county business licensing and digitise small-enterprise data across all 47 counties. It was signed in August 2026 between the chamber of commerce and the council of governors, with a national digitisation strategy called for to track growth, output and employment (memorandum). No budget, milestone or data-governance arrangement for the pooled enterprise data is stated, which matters because the pooling would cross all 47 county jurisdictions.	ADVANCED
Registries	Social protection register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Electoral register	KSh 74.8bn was appropriated for 2027 election technology, while two bills would remove the duty to livestream polling-station results. The Treasury allocated KSh 41.3bn and Parliament approved a further KSh 33.5bn; it is an appropriation and not a spend, with no procurement or equipment breakdown published (appropriation). The two bills would remove the commission's statutory duty to create a livestreaming mechanism; neither is enacted and the base does not establish how they relate procedurally (bills). A clause vesting ownership of the election technology's intellectual property and access to the election servers in the commission passed the Senate in December 2024 and has sat in committee with no report since February 2025; it is set against the 2017 refusal to open commission servers hosted abroad and a vendor's 2022 refusal of server access on intellectual-property grounds (server access). Optional iris capture was added to voter-registration kits under a roughly KSh 7bn upgrade, with nothing on file since October 2025 on deployment or enrolment (iris). Sector guidance issued in 2024 binds every organisation that touches voter data, from the commission down to civil-society registration groups, with no enforcement action under it on record as unsolicited political messaging spreads (guidance , messaging).	MIXED the appropriation nearly doubled while two bills would remove the livestreaming duty and one to vest server ownership has stalled
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Land register	The land platform has had no county-rollout update since July 2025, and no national coverage count is held at any date. One county was onboarded that month with island blocks the week before and two more counties named next (onboarding). European funders have earmarked EUR 12m for land-registration digitisation tied to the digital identity (earmark), which is the only forward commitment on the record.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Health	The health information system reaches 1,500 public facilities against a 2,000 target for 2026, while claims authorisation failures send members away to pay cash. Commitments run to 4,000 facilities by 2027 and 8,000 by 2028, with more than 50 per cent of clinical encounters to be loaded into the electronic record within one year of a facility's rollout and 90 per cent within two (framework). The statute establishing the digital health agency and an integrated information system is in force with 2025 regulations added, challenged in the High Court for inadequate public participation and operating under a Court of Appeal stay (statute and challenge). On the claims platform the Auditor-General found a KSh 104.9bn procurement that was unbudgeted and non-competitive with intellectual property ceded to the consortium (audit); the President denies a lump-sum contract and puts the figure at a ten-year total service fee (denial , reconciling term), which makes the denial one of a lump-sum procurement rather than of the arrangement or its value. No contract text is held. A second revision of the digital pharmacy guideline is in draft, widening regulation from internet pharmacy to digital pharmacy generally and reaching licensed premises, telepharmacy providers, platforms, chains and third-party technology, hosting, payment and logistics providers; its approval blocks are unsigned (guidelines).	MIXED the record system is deployed against rising targets while the claims platform fails at the counter
Sectoral management information systems	Education	The education management information system passed its September 2025 go-live target with no confirmation of coverage or learner count. The pilot was due in July 2025 and full go-live promised by September, with a unique identifier for every child; nothing is on file as at August 2026 (system). It is the one national register that would connect the identity system to schooling, and the donor project that takes half the sector's budget is meanwhile equipping junior secondary schools.	STALLED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	The child protection information system recorded cases rising from 20,235 in 2016/17 to 54,583 in 2021/22, its most recent figure four years old. It is credited with cutting duplication and improving real-time case coordination across agencies, on an academic review rather than an operator's account (review). The system is recorded as American-funded, which places it inside the aid wind-down this ledger records elsewhere, and no figure since 2021/22 exists to show whether it survived it.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	A civil-registry link to a six-city facial-recognition network is out to tender at up to KSh 25bn, with no award, contract or legal basis on file. The tender would link the civil-registry database to a closed-circuit television and facial-recognition network across six cities (tender). A separate KSh 10bn tender covers cameras, police monitoring and vehicle-detection systems at 60 junctions in the capital under a 30-month design-build contract on a foreign development loan, with the bid deadline pushed back two weeks; no data-protection authorisation, retention rule or oversight arrangement for the camera and detection systems is reported (traffic tender). The police information management system was presented in design in July 2025, consolidating fragmented systems with role-based access and a digital chain of custody, and has no build, procurement or go-live status on file thirteen months later (design).	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Tax		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	An advanced cargo declaration system entered service in August 2026, taking more than 1,000 applications in its first five days. It moves document lodgement and verification to before loading at the port of export (system). A smart gate pilot opened at one gate of the main port on 3 August 2026, integrating the customs management system with the systems of other government agencies; no cost, vendor, timetable or evaluation criterion is published.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	The platform holds more than 22,000 services from over 100 agencies at KSh 600m a day, while onboarding fell to 1,695 of 11,000. An expansion programme to 25,000 services is under way, and daily collections rose from under KSh 60m in the manual era of 2022 (services , collections). Onboarding was 3,458 of 11,000 in FY2024/25 and 1,695 to 31 March 2026, called a dismal performance, with the 2023 Executive Order unmet (migration). The operating consortium's contract still runs; the Auditor-General alleges KSh 9.4bn irregularly funnelled to private entities, flags vendor dependency as a single point of failure and recommends handover to the State, with the Attorney-General's signature missing from the contract and a special audit unconcluded (auditor , cancellation push). Draft regulations would replace the flat KSh 50 convenience fee with a value-pegged one after the High Court declared the flat fee illegal (regulations), and the platform's own vote fell to KSh 3,612.6m for FY2026/27, its first decline after two years of growth (vote , prior year).	MIXED the platform carries more services and more revenue while agency migration onto it has gone backwards

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	All 47 counties were scored on digital services, from 98.3 to 28.8, and one county completed 102.4km of fibre across its sub-counties. The assessment covers citizen experience, revenue and back-office systems, data use and employment creation, with seven counties at the top grade and six at the bottom; it is a desk review rather than a survey of users, and the report's own band percentages do not reconcile with its counts (assessment). One county connected all five sub-counties with 102.4km of fibre, nine public hotspots live and 80 further sites surveyed (county fibre).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	Binding standards for county revenue automation were gazetted in July 2026, covering the system lifecycle from procurement through audit. They require data ownership and portability safeguards to reduce vendor lock-in, and were issued by the revenue allocation commission; no compliance date, county baseline or enforcement mechanism is stated (standards). They are the first instrument in the base that addresses the vendor-dependency problem the Auditor-General flags at the national platform, and they address it at the county tier rather than the national one.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	A county telemedicine network reached 170 public health facilities with 302 more due before end-2026, from a 35-facility pilot. Fifteen doctors at a central hub handle 450 to 600 patients a day (network). It is the only rural clinical deployment in the base with a facility count and a throughput figure attached, and it is a county's rather than the health ministry's.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	Three school-connectivity commitments totalling about EUR 19.6m and GBP 4.77m are unchanged, with no outturn or schools-connected update published. One commits EUR 9.8m (last-mile schools) and another EUR 9.8m to connect 1,000 schools reaching 369,400 children across all 47 counties with per-school cost cut about 60 per cent, again with no disbursement or update (school connectivity). A bilateral programme committed GBP 4.77m to March 2027 with no outturn published (access programme). The one delivered figure is a satellite operator's: 30 schools across 30 districts reaching more than 32,000 students and about 1,000 teachers at the start of the 2026 academic year, financial terms undisclosed (satellite schools).	NO CHANGE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	A national computing platform is to be established at the technopolis with graphics-processor infrastructure for researchers, universities and startups. Progress was agreed with a development agency in July 2026, and no processor count, cost, capacity or commissioning date is published (platform). No deployed government system, model inventory or procurement is held anywhere in the base, so the state's applied position is a planned facility and a Cabinet committee.	ADVANCED
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	Nearly 45 per cent of commercial banks use the technology in credit risk assessment, on a central bank figure with no published document behind it. The account's own non-performing loan series is internally inconsistent, so only its March 2025 figures are relied on (banking use). One bank adopted its own policy during 2025 and is piloting a proprietary agent for deepfake detection at account opening; all figures are the bank's own and none is independently verified (bank policy). Both readings are from the financial sector, and neither the health, education nor revenue systems on this ledger records a deployment of its own.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	The country is one of five governments pooling datasets for an open-source African-language template, and hosts a sovereign artificial-intelligence cloud. No national funding commitment, language list or delivery date is stated for the pooling (launch , declaration). A platform marketed as the country's first sovereign-hosted cloud for such workloads runs them without sending data offshore, with no customer count, capacity or revenue figure published (sovereign cloud , partnership context). A proposed centre of African excellence for applied artificial intelligence with a bilateral partner is still at preliminary-consultation stage with no formalised agreement and nothing on file since February 2026 (centre). A digital media city and an artificial-intelligence data centre at the technopolis had a foreign export-import bank complete a due-diligence mission in August 2026, with no commitment amount, financing instrument or construction date stated (due diligence , earlier agreement).	ADVANCED
AI	Control of AI abuse	A constitutional petition challenges automated payments decisioning for offering no guaranteed route to a human agent and no disclosure of decision logic. It also alleges algorithmic discrimination in credit scoring; respondents had not filed responses at publication and nothing is on file since (petition). Pre-parliamentary proposals would amend the sexual offences statute to cover sextortion, stalking, voyeurism and artificial-intelligence-generated or altered intimate imagery, with an institutional duty to report; no bill text, sponsor or timetable is on the record (proposals).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	1,108 content-moderation and annotation jobs were cut after a platform ended its contract, while the state platform's operator pitched its registries abroad. No source after April 2026 confirms completion of the redundancies, and no figure for the country's total data-labour workforce is held (redundancies). The platform's operator holds registry deployments in two neighbouring countries and in August 2026 pitched a third on digital company registries, beneficial-ownership traceability and real-time revenue tracking, citing 40-plus digitised services; the claims are the vendor's own, made in a sales meeting, and its domestic position is separately recorded as under challenge (export pitch). Two domestic firms are named: one with products for detecting falsified content and for consent management, with no customer, deployment or revenue figure published (media verification), and one building humanoid robots rendering speech into sign language in real time with recycled-plastic casing cutting costs by over 60 per cent and delivery working over second-generation networks, every figure the founder's own (sign-language robots). A bilateral commitment to technology transfer and digital solutions for the main port carries no instrument, value or timetable (port digitalisation).	MIXED the platform operator is exporting while the data-labour sector lost more than a thousand jobs

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	A technopolis statute gives innovation cities a standalone legal framework, and three infrastructure agreements were signed at the flagship site in August 2026. The statute is in force with a development authority and a disputes tribunal, and its regulations are named as still to be finalised with no draft on file (statute , regulations). A hyperscaler signed a collaboration agreement providing technical leadership for a hybrid-cloud outpost and a startup and innovation centre of excellence, with cloud-adoption support for public bodies, certification courses for staff and young people, and credits for startups; it was signed five days after the talks were reported as exploratory, with no capacity, site, investment figure or delivery date stated and no procurement disclosed (agreement , talks). A Chinese network group signed a framework memorandum covering planning, investment, financing, design, development and maintenance of digital infrastructure at the same site, with the financing models themselves stated as still to be explored (memorandum). An African research and development lab is to be hosted at the largest commercial campus on sovereign compute, on an announcement with no opening date, funding, capacity or membership figure (lab).	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	Startup funding fell to US\$126m in the first half of 2026, the weakest half since early 2021, from US\$1.04bn raised in 2025. Equity was US\$46m of the half-year total and the country ranked third in Africa, against first place and 72 per cent year-on-year growth in 2025 (half-year); trackers disagree on both the 2025 total and the 2026 rank (half-year , full year). About US\$500m was raised across a named set of companies that have since shut down, on a publication's retrospective across five firms with no full sample, period or methodology stated (failures).	REGRESSED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	A successor programme opened in July 2026 training 150 justice-sector officials on digital evidence, with no value disclosed. It follows a closed digital-rights project (programme). It is the only civil-service digital training in the base, it covers one sector, and it is donor-funded rather than carried on any government vote.	ADVANCED
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	97.5 per cent of online adults report using an artificial-intelligence tool monthly, on a base whose school device programme has published nothing since 2022. The ranking is first globally ahead of two other countries, on a commercial compiler's survey of online adults rather than a population measure, and self-reported (survey). The national literacy programme's last published milestones are 1,170,846 devices installed in 22,891 public primary schools and 216 schools connected, carried in a 2022 government-steered review that found device use limited and learning outcomes unimproved (review); no device, school or outcome figure has been published since (review). The regulator reports supporting 23 educational institutions recently with no quantity, value or connectivity provision disclosed (donations, further donations), and an operator reports reaching over one million young people across six counties, on a self-report where reached is undefined (youth programme). Private money reached where the state programme has not: three laboratories opened at Kholera Primary, Moody Awori Primary and Ralak Girls High in the weekend to 25 August 2026 under a philanthropic global grant, taking that programme to at least 13 schools on a stated USD 91,650, against a state literacy programme running since 2016 that has not reached every school equally (laboratories).	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	Three vocational-education commitments totalling EUR 32.9m are unchanged, with no outturn or disbursement published against any of them. One commits EUR 9.9m from 2023 to 2028 (vocational digitalisation), one EUR 18m as a concessional loan from 2025 to 2030 with no disbursement published (vocational loan), and one EUR 5m from 2020 whose scheduled end year has been reached with no closure statement held (earlier loan). Against them, an education-technology fellowship selected its fourth cohort of 12 companies in July 2026, running 18 months for early-stage firms with up to US\$100,000 each in equity-free funding and scoped to learners with disabilities, refugee and rural communities, and girls and young women (fellowship); 36 companies have taken part since 2023 (fellowship).	NO CHANGE
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	The enablement programme reports more than 140,000 young people trained and 41,000 linked to opportunity, on hub counts that do not reconcile. The commissioning series reaches 117 hubs and the installed-base series about 350, on mutually inconsistent counts with no published register (117th hub , installed base). The throughput figures are the implementer's own and not independently evaluated (throughput). For the other national programme the only first-hand document held is a 2025 survey-based case study, and the state publishes no enrolment or outcome figure at any date (case study). A bill would establish a national database of qualifications maintained and published by the qualifications authority, extending to foreign qualifications, with awarding institutions required to notify within 90 days of issuing one; no enactment date, hosting arrangement or access rule is settled (bill , provisions).	ADVANCED
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy		NO EVIDENCE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	Escalated consumer complaints to the regulator rose to 670 in the quarter to June 2026 from 362 two quarters earlier. They were 563 in the prior quarter, with 548 or 82 per cent resolved (returns); data services drew 195 complaints against 44 for voice, data billing and charges was the largest single category at 75, and the regulator separately logged 19 data-breach complaints (returns). These are escalated complaints only and no comparable series before October 2025 is held, so the rise measures escalation rather than dissatisfaction. On the other side of the counter, a diaspora portal went live on the national platform for registration, missing-person and death reporting, crisis mapping and a 24-hour response centre, with no user or transaction figure held (diaspora portal).	REGRESSED
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	A riders' association petition on borrower data and vehicle tracking was committed to the Public Petitions Committee in August 2026. It alleges that an asset financier breaches data-protection law in its collection, processing, storage and sharing of borrowers' personal data and in the tracking devices fitted to financed motorcycles (petition). No finding, regulator action or company response is held. It is the base's clearest instance of a constituency reaching a digital-rights question through Parliament rather than through the regulator.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Gender equity	Internet use runs at 37.8 per cent of men against 32.2 per cent of women, with rural mobile ownership at 48.6 per cent against 64.6 urban. Urban internet penetration is 56.5 per cent against 25 per cent rural, and more than 42 per cent of women micro-entrepreneurs who own a device use it mainly for personal communication rather than business (figures); the figures are attributed to the statistics bureau and the regulator but cited in a training write-up rather than taken from a published release (figures). A women's digital accelerator opened trainer-of-trainers cohorts in the capital on 19 August 2026 for a first 100 women instructors and in a second county on 24 to 26 August, against a goal of 15,000 women trained across three counties by 2028 (second county); participants are certified after a post-training evaluation, and the organisers state that funding partners scaled back support after aid cuts, forcing a reduction in the project's original scope (second county , first cohort).	MIXED a training accelerator opened its second county while the measured gaps in use and ownership persist
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities	The 2025 disability statute is in force setting no artificial-intelligence accessibility standards and no enforcement mechanism. The gap is named in an academic analysis rather than by the regulator (analysis). It matters against what this ledger records elsewhere: automated decisioning is running on the country's largest payments rail, three draft guidance notes read the data statute onto the technology, and none of them carries an accessibility requirement.	NO CHANGE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	A GBP 2.3m programme across eight arid-lands counties including two refugee-hosting counties passed its March 2026 completion date with no report held. Activities were to start in late 2025 (programme). Against it, American-funded inclusion and connectivity programming including work in remote counties slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down, with no replacement funder named (withdrawal).	REGRESSED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	588 digital hub sites are committed against a target of one per ward, and smartphone connections passed 50m for the first time. Forty-six centres of excellence and forty standard hubs are under construction, procurement of 10,000 locally assembled desktops is complete for the first 100 pilot hubs and a further 10,000 is in final stages (hubs); these are committed sites rather than completed hubs and are not reconciled against the separate enablement programme's installed-base series (hubs , prior count). A separate plan for 100 county centres of excellence broke ground on its first at Kikuyu on 21 August 2026, with no budget, timetable or site list stated and no statement of how the two programmes relate (county hubs). The universal service fund connected 20 sub-locations in FY2024/25 and 155 cumulatively, reaching about 508,012 people, with construction started at 32 of 47 planned centres (fund); no FY2025/26 account is published, and no levy rate or fund balance is held (fund). A fund skilling project targets 120,000 people in 19 counties over three years, with no budget line, delivery partner, county list or start date published (skilling). Smartphone connections reached 50.2m in March 2026 with feature phones down to 28.5m (devices), while American-funded inclusion programming slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down (withdrawal).	MIXED hub programmes expanded while the fund's own delivery account stopped and donor programming withdrew

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Censuses and surveys		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	The statistics office's ICT chapter runs to 2024 and a year behind the regulator's quarterly returns, with no 2026 edition held. It puts mobile subscriptions at 71.4m and 136.1 per 100 inhabitants in 2024, fixed and wireless internet subscriptions at 57.8m and mobile-money subscriptions at 42.3m (survey). A collaboration to explore anonymised aggregated mobile data for population, mobility and socio-economic insight was announced in June 2026, with no scope, governance terms or start date (partnership).	NO CHANGE
Open data	Use of open data	The ministry asked that electronic legal deposit and a national digital knowledge repository be written into the library service bill. The requests were made at a Senate committee hearing on 4 August 2026 and also cover digital preservation of public records, artificial-intelligence-supported cataloguing and interoperability with government digital infrastructure; the bill is held only as an unreadable image, so its own provisions cannot be stated (hearing). Against that, the state's other open-data instrument is a proposal to sell rather than publish: a marketplace of more than 1,000 datasets at KSh 396m to build and operate (marketplace).	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	An academy proposal is unsigned and a cloud collaboration is unchanged, with no expansion, spend figure or workload detail published. The academy would be the region's first and was disclosed at a summit sideline, with no agreement, funding, cohort size or date (proposal). The cloud collaboration covers fraud detection, customer-service automation and engineer upskilling and has not moved since June 2025 (collaboration). The substantive American engagement on this ledger is elsewhere: a health cooperation framework under litigation, and an aid withdrawal that stopped inclusion programming.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	Two delegations were received in eight days on broadband, smart cities and technology investment, with nothing signed, valued or scheduled. The second was a provincial service centre's delegation on investment, connectivity and innovation partnerships, a week after a network group's visit; two courtesy calls in eight days is a pattern of approach and not an investment (talks , first visit). A vendor states student training under way and an East Africa research and development centre planned, framed by the ministry around all-optical networks and sixth-generation readiness; the account is a vendor event and a ministry statement at it, with no contract, value or date stated (vendor). An electronic-commerce cooperation memorandum is cited as the basis for dispatching eighteen officers to a Chinese province for a trade matching activity, its signature date, terms and text not held (memorandum).	ADVANCED
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	A European data-adequacy decision is described as in prospect, on a third party's passing reference with no application or timetable stated. No European Commission or government statement is on file (reference). Cooperation was separately reaffirmed at principal-secretary level across artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, digital identity, interoperability and digital governance, with no agreement text, workplan, timetable or funding figure published (cooperation).	ADVANCED
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	A trilateral sovereign artificial-intelligence partnership targets 100 deployment programmes by 2030 on multilingual low-bandwidth voice systems. It was launched at a summit in February 2026 as a three-country arrangement, and no programme delivery, budget, participating institution or first deployment has been reported anywhere since (partnership).	NO CHANGE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
CA spectrum-interference audit, direct-to-cell	a published CA determination or gazette notice would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, no CA determination or gazette notice on interference published; trade reporting only	2026-08-05

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Data-centre power tariff or grid-connection framework	a published EPRA or Kenya Power data-centre tariff, or a gazetted large-load connection rule, would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, EPRA tariffs and open-access regulations carry no data-centre category and no large-load connection rule	2026-08-05
National earth-observation data programme	a Kenya Space Agency strategy or national earth-observation data policy would settle it; every satellite-data source the place holds is continental or vendor-side; probed 2026-08-05, KSA Strategic Plan 2023-2027 located; the EO Data Sharing Framework 2026 itself is a landing page only	2026-08-05
Registered data controllers and processors	the ODPC register or its annual report would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, the statutory register is public and live; a total needs pagination traversal, not a single fetch	2026-08-05
Installed AI compute capacity	no held source states Kenya's installed GPU or accelerator capacity; a ministry or regulator inventory would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, no ministry or regulator inventory exists; the nearest official statement is a Konza transaction document giving 0.7MW IT capacity, 144 racks and no dedicated GPU clusters; on ingest the Konza transaction document proved to be dated 2026-04-13, not 2020, so its 0.7MW / 144-rack / no-GPU-cluster statement is current rather than historical	2026-08-05
Ajira Digital Programme	the state's other flagship digital-work programme is effectively absent from the base; probed 2026-08-05, no official programme report retrievable and ajiradigital.go.ke renders only a broken interface; an SSRN case study is the only first-hand document reached	2026-08-05
Malabo Convention ratification position	An instrument of signature, ratification or accession to the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection, or an official statement of the government's position on it.	2026-08-14

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.